

Cohesity

AI Data Security / Data Protection · San Jose, CA · Private (Nvidia-backed; 2026 IPO, valuation benchmarked vs Rubrik)

Nvidia-backed Cohesity reached ~\$1.5B pro-forma ARR (revenue \$1.7B+) after completing its Veritas combination in Dec 2024 and is steering toward a 2026 IPO benchmarked against public peer Rubrik (~\$14.5B today) - with no pure-play backup and data-resilience brand yet owning the F1 grid.

81

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Williams

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Cohesity is the rare combination our mandate prizes most: an established category leader arriving at a brand-reckoning moment with budget, motive and a clear strategic angle. After completing its combination with Veritas' data-protection business on 10 December 2024, the merged company reported pro-forma annual recurring revenue of roughly \$1.5 billion (revenue over \$1.7 billion) at a 28% adjusted cash-EBITDA margin, and the Nvidia-backed company is now steering toward a 2026 IPO with a valuation its CEO has benchmarked against publicly traded peer Rubrik (a ~\$14.5B market cap as of May 2026; the Sep-2025 CNBC report that framed the comparison cited Rubrik at ~\$17B). Two things make it a 1440 target rather than just a big company. First, it has never touched motorsport, so an approach now is early - we would not be the hundredth agency in the inbox. Second, while Williams already fields a data-platform partner (VAST Data) and a cybersecurity partner (Keeper Security), no pure-play enterprise backup, recovery and ransomware-resilience brand yet owns a presence on the F1 grid - a distinct, adjacent lane Cohesity could define rather than share. The IPO is the forcing function that turns 'someday' into 'this year'.

WHY NOW

An IPO is the single largest brand-elevation event in a company's life, and the 12 months around it are when leadership spends most deliberately on institutional credibility - exactly the currency a multi-year F1 partnership trades in. Signing around the listing lets Cohesity convert a finance milestone into a global enterprise-brand statement, pre-build the recognition that public investors reward, and secure backup-and-resilience category exclusivity before a direct rival (Rubrik, Veeam, Commvault) claims the same adjacent lane. The post-Veritas integration narrative also benefits from a single, high-visibility external proof point that the merged company is now one coherent market leader.

SPINOFF UNICORN

NEVER ENTERED

FUNDING EVENT

DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY WILLIAMS

Williams is a credible canvas: a data-and-engineering revival anchored by title partner Atlassian and data-platform partner VAST Data, which makes it one of the grid's most data-literate teams. Crucially, Williams' existing tech roster is adjacent rather than competing - VAST Data handles storage and analytics and Keeper Security covers identity and privileged-access security, leaving backup, rapid recovery and ransomware resilience as a genuinely distinct layer Cohesity would own. That lets Cohesity reinforce, rather than collide with, the roster while standing out to the enterprise-IT decision-makers in Williams' hospitality suites. Judgment call to confirm before outreach: if that data-security adjacency reads as too crowded for a clean category story, Williams remains the lead option but the same thesis travels to another data-literate team.

VALUE TO WILLIAMS — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - a real operational fit, not just signage. A Williams race weekend produces and must safeguard enormous volumes of telemetry, simulation data and proprietary design IP, and any loss or compromise is a competitive catastrophe. That is precisely Cohesity's domain: backup, rapid recovery and ransomware resilience - the recovery layer beneath the storage VAST Data already provides and the access security Keeper already runs. The partnership can be built around an actual data-protection deployment for the team's race and factory data, giving Williams genuine operational value and a defensible 'we protect the data that wins races' story, while Cohesity gains a marquee reference customer it can name on the IPO roadshow. The exchange is tangible on both sides.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Data Resilience Partner tier on Williams. MINIMUM THREE YEARS - ideally four, to span the IPO and the post-listing brand-build cycle - at an estimated \$4-7M/yr. Scope: garage and cockpit branding in the backup-and-recovery category, hospitality at marquee rounds, digital rights targeting an enterprise-IT audience, a working data-protection deployment for the team, and exclusivity scoped to backup/recovery/ ransomware-resilience (distinct from Williams' existing storage and identity-security partners) to keep direct rivals off the car.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Carol Carpenter
CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, COHESITY - VERIFIED VIA COHESITY NEWSROOM

Cohesity's first CMO, leading the global marketing organisation. Previously CMO at Unity and CMO at VMware (where her teams drove the multi-cloud repositioning) - a seasoned enterprise brand-builder running exactly the kind of category-defining, IPO-readiness brand programme an F1 partnership would anchor. Co-decision-makers for a spend of this size: CEO Sanjay Poonen (ex-VMware) and the IR/CFO function during the listing window.

OPENING ANGLE

"Carol, you've run the brand through a VMware-scale repositioning - you know an IPO is won on credibility, not noise. Backup and ransomware-recovery is the one enterprise-resilience lane no brand on the F1 grid has claimed. Worth 25 minutes to own it before the roadshow locks?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 18 / 20 Targeting a 2026 IPO - the brand-reckoning moment for a category leader. The Veritas combination completed 10 Dec 2024 brought the merged company to ~\$1.5B pro-forma ARR, and it is actively building an institutional-grade brand for the roadshow.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 Pro-forma ARR ~\$1.5B (revenue \$1.7B+) at a 28% adjusted cash-EBITDA margin, Nvidia-backed, with a 2026 IPO valuation benchmarked against public peer Rubrik (~\$14.5B market cap, May 2026). Title-adjacent spend is comfortably within reach.	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 Backup, recovery and ransomware resilience map cleanly to F1's data-obsessed, zero-failure engineering culture. Williams already has a storage partner (VAST Data) and a cybersecurity partner (Keeper Security), but no pure-play backup/recovery brand owns the grid - an adjacent, ownable lane (score moderated to reflect that the broader data-security space on Williams is partly occupied).	URGENCY 15 / 20 The IPO window is a one-time elevation moment, and public peer Rubrik (~\$14.5B) already raises the category's competitive temperature; a grid presence differentiates the listing.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: an F1 team generates and must protect petabytes of telemetry, simulation output and design IP - a genuine, demonstrable data-resilience use case in the garage.
---	---	--	---	---

RISKS & COUNTERS

IPO QUIET PERIOD Securities rules may restrict marketing announcements in the weeks around the listing. **Counter:** Negotiate and sign quietly, then activate post-listing; use the roadshow period to build internal consensus rather than to announce.

INTEGRATION FOCUS Post-Veritas integration may absorb leadership attention and budget. **Counter:** Position the deal as the single external proof point that the merged company is now one unified category leader - an integration accelerant, not a distraction.

SOURCES

- <https://www.cnn.com/2025/09/04/nvidia-backed-cohesity-eyes-2026-ipo-with-valuation-rivaling-17-billion-rubrik.html>
- <https://www.cohesity.com/newsroom/press/cohesity-appoints-carol-carpenter-as-chief-marketing-officer/>
- <https://www.cohesity.com/newsroom/press/cohesity-celebrates-grand-opening-san-jose-hq-dec-11/>
- <https://www.williamsf1.com/posts/fce0ff58-774b-431e-8109-063f548aeb33/williams-racing-cybersecurity-partnership-keeper-security>
- <https://www.vastdata.com/press-releases/atlassian-williams-racing-and-vast-data-extend-partnership-with-multi-year>
- <https://stockanalysis.com/stocks/rbrk/market-cap/>
- <https://strategyofsecurity.com/p/cybersecuritys-ipo-pipeline-2026-and-beyond>